r, type SEL to find the SELECT statement you'd just run. Reverse searching for past queries helps, and you can run the \g to run the last statement again.

The history is kept in the file ~/.psql_history by default. The history file is meant to be read within psql[2] although it's a plain text file.

If you'd like to customize the location or to generate a distinct file for each database, you may customize the HISTFILE. You can increase HISTSIZE to keep more information in the file.

Any of these customizations can be added to a special ~/.psqlrc file that's read when psql starts up. The Thoughtbot post *An Explained psqlrc*[3] shows how to customize ~/.psqlrc with lots of great tips.

You may also want to edit queries directly in a text editor from psql. To do that, use the \e meta-command.

Within the text editor, type out SQL queries, wrapping lines and doing formatting as you like. When you save your changes you're returned to psql and the query executes.

To save your SQL query output to a file from psql use the \o meta command, like \o file.txt, where file.txt contains the query results.

With this option, when you run a query the results are written directly into this file and no output is visible in psql. To toggle it back type \o without a filename. You should now see output again in psql when you run \g.

To exit psql, type \q. View the contents of the output file by running cat file.txt from your Terminal. The file will show the query results in the same way as they'd appear in psql.

Refer to the meta commands recap below.

Command	Description
\set	Set a variable
\s	See history of commands
\e	Launch a text editor from The code tag should not be here.
\o	Toggle output between The code tag should not be here. and a file query output to a file from

Great, hopefully you're picking up some new psql tips.

2. https://stackoverflow.com/a/31649807
3. https://thoughtbot.com/blog/an-explained-psqlrc